



EZY OS — Your Second Brain Stack: Claude Code + Obsidian

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Every time you start a new Claude Code session, it starts from zero. Your decisions, your context, your preferences — gone. You re-explain the same things every single time.

Obsidian fixes that. With the right setup, Claude Code reads your entire vault, writes new notes, routes operations intelligently, and keeps everything versioned across devices. Five setups. All free. All inside Claude Code. Your second brain, fully wired in.

WHAT YOU NEED

- Claude Code installed (free at claude.ai/code)
- Obsidian installed (free at obsidian.md)
- 15 minutes
- A folder somewhere for your vault (I use `~/brain`) Total setup time: 15 minutes

SETUP 01 — VAULT MCP

The mcp-obsidian server exposes your entire Obsidian vault to Claude Code. Full-text search, frontmatter, backlinks, tags — Claude reads every note, writes new ones, and ranks by relevance with BM25. No more copy-pasting notes into chat. Claude just knows your vault.

Step 1: Inside Obsidian, go to Settings → Community plugins → Browse Step 2: Install and enable "Local REST API". Copy the API key from its settings Step 3: In your terminal, run: `claude mcp add obsidian-mcp -s user -- uvx mcp-obsidian` Step 4: Set `OBSIDIAN_API_KEY` in your environment (or in the MCP config JSON) Step 5: Restart Claude Code. Test with: "Search my vault for notes about pricing"

Pro tip: Use the `-s user` flag so the MCP is available in every project, not just the current one. Your second brain should follow you everywhere.

SETUP 02 — CLAUDE SIDEBAR

Derek Larson's Obsidian Claude Sidebar plugin embeds a full Claude Code terminal inside Obsidian's right panel. You watch Claude read your notes, make edits, and create new



pages in real time — without switching windows. Multiple tabs for parallel conversations. Auto-detects your Vault MCP.

Step 1: Install the Claude Sidebar community plugin in Obsidian Step 2: Make sure Claude Code CLI is installed and accessible from your terminal Step 3: (Windows only) Run pip install pywinpty — one-time fix for terminal emulation Step 4: Click the bot icon in Obsidian's ribbon (or set a hotkey) Step 5: Claude Code launches in the sidebar and auto-detects your MCP server

Pro tip: Use multiple tabs. One for research ("pull everything on positioning"), one for building ("draft the landing page"). Parallel conversations without ever leaving the vault.

SETUP 03 — OBSIDIAN SKILL

The Obsidian Skill (v0.11, March 2026) teaches Claude to use your vault properly. It routes operations to the right tool — MCP for search, CLI for daily notes, Git for sync. Preflight checks, tag scanning, and active-file awareness built in. Claude stops guessing and starts operating your vault like a power user.

Step 1: In your terminal, run: npx skills add <https://github.com/bitbonsai/mcpvault> Step 2: Or install via the Claude marketplace: /plugin install obsidian-skill Step 3: Restart Claude Code Step 4: Invoke with /obsidian — Claude preflights vault + git + MCP before doing anything Step 5: Operations now automatically target the correct tool and the correct note

Pro tip: Drop this skill into your ~/.claude/skills folder so it loads globally. Every project inherits the routing logic. No per-project setup.

SETUP 04 — KNOWLEDGE COMPILER

Karpathy's wiki-note pattern (posted April 2026, 19M+ views on X). Instead of starting fresh each session, you compile raw research and notes into organised wiki pages. Every new source updates 10-15 related notes via [[backlinks]]. The knowledge compounds — your vault becomes a personal knowledge engine, not a note dump.

Step 1: Create a /moc folder (Maps of Content) in your vault Step 2: Start with one topic note — e.g., "Positioning MOC" Step 3: Tell Claude: "Read this article and update my Positioning MOC with new insights. Create [[backlinks]] to related notes." Step 4: Claude extracts key ideas, updates the MOC, creates cross-links to existing notes Step 5: Rinse and repeat for every article, book, podcast, or meeting note



Pro tip: Review your MOCs monthly. The graph view in Obsidian shows you which ideas cluster — dense clusters are where your real expertise is forming. That's where your content should come from.

SETUP 05 — GIT SYNC + DAILY NOTES

Git-backed version control plus auto-generated daily notes. Your vault syncs across Mac, iPhone, and iPad — no Obsidian Sync subscription. Claude auto-generates tomorrow's daily note from today's context — tasks carried forward, meetings linked, open threads tracked.

Step 1: In your vault folder, run: `git init` & `git remote add origin [your repo]` Step 2: Install the Obsidian Git community plugin — set it to auto-commit every 10 minutes Step 3: Create a /daily folder and a daily note template with frontmatter (tags, weather, mood) Step 4: Tell Claude: "Generate tomorrow's daily note — carry forward open tasks, link my calendar" Step 5: Claude writes the note, commits to git, pushes across all devices

Pro tip: If git feels heavy, use iCloud or Dropbox for sync. Still versioned via file history. Zero subscription, zero setup friction.

REAL USE CASES

✓ "Search my vault for every note on ICP" — instant recall across hundreds of notes ✓
"Pull every open question from Q2 notes into a review doc" — Claude reads, synthesises, creates ✓
"Read my brand voice note and rewrite this landing copy" — on-brand from the first draft ✓
"Compile this article into my Positioning MOC" — knowledge compounds automatically ✓
"Generate tomorrow's daily note from today's context" — planning handled before you sleep

WHAT'S NEXT

A second brain is only as valuable as what you put in it. The more context you capture, the smarter every Claude Code session gets. Start with Setup 01 (Vault MCP) — everything else stacks on top of it.

EZY OS is where the training and the tools come together. Learn the skill, apply it immediately inside the system. Founding access is open at ezye.com.au/os.